

Tips & Tricks

SECRETS THAT KEEP YOU AHEAD IN THE RACE

TIPS

Powerpoint 2007
Irfanview
Game Easter Eggs

63
65
70

30 MINUTES EXPERT

Simplify the Machine

66

POWERPOINT 2007



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Those in marketing can't live without it, your friends often spam you with an offspring of it that contains a corny message, and most presentations depend on it. The beauty of PowerPoint is that it can be used for both personal and professional use, so if you have to present your ideas at a sales meet, your college, or want to irritate your friends with your philosophies on tree-hugging, keep reading...



The Return Of The Ribbon

When you launch PowerPoint 2007, you'll be greeted with the now-famous Ribbon. We're not going to go in depth about it again, because we have already discussed it in previous

Tips & Tricks. It should take no more than a few minutes for you to feel at home here, whether you've used other Office 2007 applications or not. You will see tabs such as Home, Insert, Design, Animations, Slide Show, Review, and View. From time to time you will see another tab, such as Format, appear when you perform actions in PowerPoint. These are called contextual tabs, which appear only when they are needed, or can be used. You should keep an eye open for them while working to find options easily.



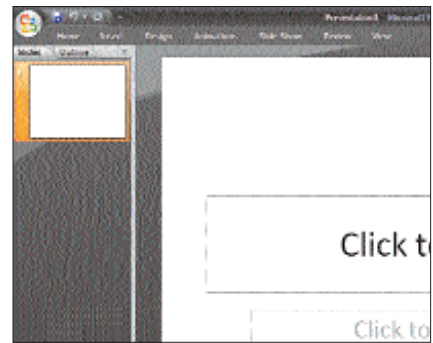
More...

The Ribbon displays almost every setting and effect possible, but not all of them. Keep an eye out for the little downward facing arrows and "More Options..." buttons to see all the options available in every menu. This is especially important for transition effects and the like in PowerPoint. Also make sure to use the live preview feature that has made Office 2007 popular in the first place, so as to see what changes will occur before actually applying them. Just mouse over any option on the menu and you will see what that will do to your slide.



Minimise The Ribbon

For those who want more Desktop area to work with, the ribbon might get in the way. This is especially true for those working on resolutions of 1024x768 or lower—Office 2007 seems to demand higher resolutions. In order to minimise the Ribbon, just right-click on any of the tab names and select "Minimize the Ribbon". Now you will be



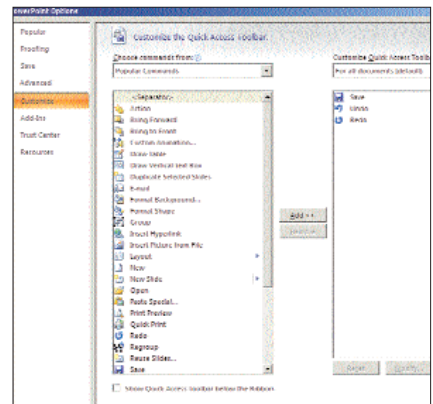
A minimised Ribbon provides more space

able to see all the names of the tabs, but not all the buttons. When you need to do some formatting or changes, just click on the name of a tab and all the buttons will return in all their glory. A single click means that the ribbon will auto-hide, and a double-click will keep it there permanently.



Customise The Quick Access Bar

By default, next to the Office logo you find the Quick Access toolbar. By



What do you want Quick Access to?

default this has a shortcut to Save, Undo, and Redo, which is a little pointless, because we're all quite adept at using the respective keyboard shortcuts. However, each of us may have some task that we perform regularly, which have difficult to remember keyboard shortcuts, or complicated ones requiring key combinations. In such cases, it would be wise to customise the Quick Access toolbar. Just right-click on the toolbar and select "Customize Quick Access Toolbar". Now choose the shortcuts you want to display on the Quick Access toolbar and click OK.



Easy Keyboard Shortcuts

For keyboard warriors, the most irritating thing about the new PowerPoint is the fact that a few of the shortcuts have changed. What most people don't realise is that Office 2007